Project Activity: Build the Conceptual Models That Bring Your Stories to Life

Sample Solution:
Seat Reservation Story of Use

Story of Use 1: Too Detailed

The Scenario:

Lucy and her ten-year-old daughter, Grace, are preparing to fly from San Francisco to Orlando to attend a large family reunion at Disney World. The tickets were purchased online two months ago by Lucy's brother, David, who graciously bought flights for the entire extended family so they could celebrate their parents' 50th wedding anniversary together. Since David made all the arrangements for everyone, Lucy received an email confirmation with e-tickets attached rather than booking the flights herself.

As the big trip approaches, Lucy grows worried about ensuring that she and Grace can sit next to each other on both legs of the journey—outbound and return. She knows her daughter can get anxious during flights, especially during takeoff and landing, so being separated on the plane is out of the question. With the e-ticket confirmation numbers in hand, Lucy logs onto the airline's reservation system to manage her seats.

1. Accessing the Airline Reservation System

Lucy opens her laptop one evening after dinner. She navigates to the airline's official website, where a "Manage My Booking" tab promises she can make changes to seat assignments. The system asks for the following details:

1. **Last Name:** Lucy enters her surname, "Henderson."
2. **Booking Reference (PNR):** This six-character alphanumeric code was included in David's email, labeled as "Record Locator." Lucy carefully types it in.
3. **Departure City and Date:** The website prompts Lucy to confirm the initial departure city (San Francisco) and date of travel (July 8).

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After inputting these details correctly, Lucy clicks “Find My Booking.” The website loads her reservation, showing both the outbound flight (SFO → MCO) and the return flight (MCO → SFO) for Lucy and Grace.

2. Reviewing Flight Details

Under the reservation, Lucy sees a brief summary:

- **Flight 1:** SFO to MCO, July 8, 9:00 AM – 5:30 PM (with one-hour layover in Dallas).
- **Flight 2:** MCO to SFO, July 15, 7:00 PM – 11:00 PM (direct flight).

She notices each flight has a separate flight number:

- **Outbound:** Flight #AA1234 (SFO → DFW), connecting to Flight #AA5678 (DFW → MCO)
- **Return:** Flight #AA9101 (MCO → SFO direct)

The airline system displays that seat assignments have not yet been finalized for either flight because David purchased the group fares in bulk. Individual seat selection remained pending to allow each family to arrange seating around their preferences. With one glance, Lucy realizes she needs to finalize seats before more people from the extended family (or other passengers entirely) start picking their preferred spots.

3. Exploring Seat Selection

A button labeled “Choose or Modify Seats” appears next to each flight segment. Lucy starts with the outbound flight from San Francisco to Dallas (the first leg). She clicks through to view a seat map—a visual grid representing the plane’s layout. The seat map uses different icons and colors to denote:

- **Available Seats** (open for selection)
- **Occupied Seats** (taken by other passengers)
- **Extra Legroom/Premium Seats** (with an additional fee)

Although some seats are already taken, Lucy spots two adjacent aisle seats in row 15, across from the galley. She selects them for both herself and Grace. The system shows a small dialog box explaining that Row 15 is also near the wing. Since Grace sometimes likes looking out of the window to see the clouds, Lucy debates whether to pick a window seat, but those appear to be scattered or already booked, making it impossible for them to remain side by side without paying a substantial premium. For the sake of staying together, Lucy confirms the two aisle seats in Row 15.

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Saving Selections

Once she confirms seat selection for the first flight, she repeats the process for the second leg of the outbound journey (Dallas to Orlando). Fortunately, a pair of adjacent seats in Row 20 is available—one window, one middle. This is perfect for Grace's excitement about the view outside the plane. Lucy checks the box for those seats and sees a small green message pop up: "Your seats have been reserved successfully."

4. Reviewing the Return Flight

Lucy feels relieved until she remembers she also needs to reserve seats on the return flight. She heads back to the main "Manage My Booking" page and selects the return flight from Orlando to San Francisco. This flight is direct, so there's only one leg to worry about. However, it's a popular route at a busy time—many seats are already taken by other tourists returning from summer vacations.

On the seat map, Lucy sees that most of the seats in the front half of the plane are occupied. Toward the rear, seats appear more available. After scrolling, she finds two adjacent seats in Row 28—one middle and one aisle. Satisfied that they can still sit together, Lucy selects those seats. The airline system confirms: "Seats 28D (Aisle) and 28E (Middle) have been assigned to your reservation."

5. Addressing Potential Issues

Before finalizing, Lucy double-checks that there are no additional fees associated with these seat assignments. Some airlines charge extra for certain seat categories, and Lucy wants to avoid any unexpected charges. The screen indicates a minimal seat selection fee, which David already covered as part of the family travel plan, so Lucy doesn't have to pay out of pocket.

Lucy also notices a note about seat changes: "Seat assignments may be altered for operational reasons; check in early to ensure final seat selection." She makes a mental note to check in online as soon as it's allowed—usually 24 hours before departure—to confirm they haven't been moved around by the airline.

6. Additional Services and Final Confirmation

Having selected seats, Lucy decides to handle a few extra details. She updates the Frequent Flyer field with her own membership number to accumulate miles for both herself and Grace. Since she's already in the system, Lucy also checks whether she can request a child's meal for Grace. The system provides dietary preference choices for the Dallas-to-Orlando segment, so Lucy opts for a child-friendly meal. She sees a confirmation screen: "Child meal added to your itinerary."

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Finally, Lucy reviews the entire reservation:

- **Outbound (SFO → DFW → MCO):** Seats 15C and 15D for the first leg, Seats 20A and 20B for the second.
- **Return (MCO → SFO):** Seats 28D and 28E.
- **Dietary Preference (Dallas → Orlando Segment):** Child Meal.

Pleased with the outcome, Lucy clicks “Confirm Reservation.” The system sends an automated email with updated e-ticket information, reflecting the chosen seats and dietary preferences.

7. Post-Reservation Follow-Up

Over the next few weeks, Lucy occasionally logs into the airline reservation system just to ensure no last-minute changes have occurred. She also forwards the updated seat assignment information to David, who is managing the overall family trip itinerary. By doing this, David knows Lucy and Grace’s seat details and can coordinate if someone else in the group also needs a change or if there are any last-minute schedule adjustments.

On departure day, Lucy plans to complete online check-in 24 hours before the flight. By doing so, she can verify that her seat choices are still intact and print her boarding passes (or store them on her phone). Come travel day, Lucy and Grace will arrive at San Francisco International Airport early, breezing through bag drop and security with peace of mind, knowing they’ll be side by side in the airplane.

End of Story

This scenario walks you through the **full journey** of using an airline reservation system: accessing the “Manage My Booking” section, selecting seats for both outbound and return flights, handling extra needs like meal preferences, and finally confirming all the details. The mother (Lucy) and her daughter (Grace) remain at the heart of the story, demonstrating the practical concerns of a parent wanting to ensure comfort and safety for her child, all within the context of a larger family reunion.

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Story of Use 2: Improved

The nouns that need to be added to the conceptual model are marked in bold.

Lucy and her ten-year-old daughter, Grace, are preparing to fly from San Francisco to Orlando for a big family reunion at Disney World. The tickets were kindly purchased by Lucy's brother, David, who arranged flights for everyone in their extended family. As a result, Lucy received an email with two e-ticket confirmations rather than booking directly herself.

Because Grace can feel uneasy when seated apart, Lucy wants to make sure they sit side by side on both the outbound and return journeys. She visits the airline's website and clicks "Manage My Booking." After entering her **last name**, the **booking reference** from David's email, and the **departure details**, Lucy can see their **reservation**. It shows both flights (**outbound** with a connection, then a direct **return**) but indicates no **seat assignments** yet—common with group-purchased fares.

Lucy opens the **seat map** for the **first leg** and examines the available options. She notices that seats in the first few rows of the main cabin are marked as "**Premium Economy**" with a small icon indicating extra legroom and priority boarding privileges. Although these seats come with an additional charge of $45 per person, Lucy decides they would be worth it for the longer first leg of their journey. She selects two adjacent seats in row 8—an aisle and middle seat—and sees a notification that these selections will **add $90 to her total**.

For the connecting flight, which is shorter, Lucy opts for a more economical choice. A window and middle seat are free side by side in the standard economy section, so she selects them without incurring additional fees. She repeats the process for the **return leg** but decides to splurge again, selecting two premium seats near the front of the cabin that offer early deplaning advantages, which will be helpful after a tiring day at Disney. These seats add another $110 to her bill.

Before finalizing her selections, a **summary screen** displays all her chosen seats with a total additional charge of $200. Lucy clicks "Continue to Payment" and is directed to a secure checkout page. Here, she enters her credit card information, confirms the billing address matches her card, and reviews all charges one final time. A pop-up notes possible seat reassignments for operational reasons, prompting Lucy to remember to check in online early despite having paid for premium seating.

After **submitting payment**, Lucy receives a confirmation screen with a transaction number. She updates her frequent-flyer number, requests a child's meal for Grace on one segment, and completes the process. Minutes later, an **email** arrives with a **revised itinerary** showing her **chosen seats** and a **receipt for the seat upgrade charges**. Relieved, Lucy forwards the details to David and sets a reminder to complete online check-in 24 hours before departure, ensuring she and Grace can sit together in their premium seats without issue on their upcoming trip.

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